St. Pius X 101 FAQs

DISCLAIMER: *The information contained in this document is updated regularly based on information provided to the St. Pius X Mothers' Club Ambassador Committee by St. Pius X school administration. It is in NO WAY a replacement for or in lieu of official communication or policies provided in the Student Handbook, school website, eSpiritus weekly newsletter or other direct communication from St. Pius X administration, faculty and staff, please refer to this document for who to ask. This document is intended to help Parent Ambassadors provide useful information to parents new to the SPX community. Any questions regarding this document can be directed to SPXMothersClub@spxstudent.org.*

Should I be checking my family @spxstudent.org email account?

+ YES!! Regularly. All communication from the school will be sent to this email address - READ THEM!
+ The eSpiritus e-newsletter is sent every Monday, generally by noon, and includes news & important dates for the week and month ahead. ***This is the single most important email to read!!***
+ Additional emails will be sent for last-minute schedule changes & important announcements usually from Rachel Braham or Chris Murphy, Deans of Students, if needed.
+ Students may get the same or similar emails sent to their student email accounts.
+ Teachers are required to use this email account if they need to communicate with you.
+ **You must be logged into your family SPX email account to fill out SPX Google forms!!**

What other sources of information should I be familiar with?

+ School website **www.spx.org** - general school wide information, announcements & calendar.
+ Student Handbook - must review and sign acknowledgement forms each year.
+ The best reference for new families is the "**New Family Resources**" found under Admissions.
+ The most useful tab is "**Current Families**" at top right - quickly gets you to the Student Handbook, log-in pages for *PowerSchool*, *Canvas*, *Scoir* and QuickLinks to forms & organizations.
+ **SPX Calendar** - accessed directly from top right of website - instructions for subscribing & adding to your own personal calendar on the right hand side.
+ Follow SPX Social Media accounts:
  Instagram: **https://www.instagram.com/spxatl/**
  X: **https://x.com/stpiusxatlanta**
  Facebook: **https://www.facebook.com/StPiusXAtlanta**

What time does school begin and end?

Normal Schedule: 8:00am - 3:00pm

+ First bell rings at 7:55am & second bell at 8:00am (students must be in their first period class by 8:00am)
+ 8 class periods, 46 minutes each with 5 minutes in between
+ Lunch is a full class period (4th, 5th, or 6th)
+ Daily morning prayer and Pledge of Allegiance start the day.
+ Daily Announcements and afternoon prayer close out the day at the end of 8th period

What are "late start" days?

Late Start: 8:40am - 3:00pm

+ USUALLY on FRIDAYS but occasionally can be on other weekdays
+ Staff meetings before school
+ Students must remain in the cafeteria until the bell at 8:30 a.m.
+ 8 shorter class periods with 5 minutes in between
+ Used for Mass days, assemblies, special events (pep rallies, etc.)
+ Special schedules are available on the desktop version of PowerSchool (can see all school days' schedules) & communicated via eSpiritus weekly.

How does student drop off/pick up work?

Students can be dropped off on campus as early as 6:30am

+ Front and back gates will be open for students to enter and hang out in the Cafeteria
+ Drop off in frontcircle, back by Roar Store/Gym or Donnellan/Football Stadium
+ Afternoon pick-up is both in the front and back, as well, but can be throughout campus and along Frontier Rd (the street between the main campus and Seaver Field). Be mindful of the homes neighboring the campus.
+ **Speed cameras on Johnson Rd & Plaster Rd are in effect all day long - BE CAREFUL!**
+ Additional information is provided here.

When will my student get their student ID?

+ Photos are taken during lunch the first week of school in uniform & students usually get their ID sometime in early October. Freshmen and new students receive a temporary ID to use until their photo card comes in.
+ This photo is both their ID card photo & yearbook photo.
+ Students need their ID card for the cafeteria, library, sporting events & arts performances.
+ Lanyards are encouraged but not required.
+ If a student forgets or loses their ID, they must visit the Dean of Students office to have a new one printed & their FACTs account is charged $15 each time it's reprinted.

How does the Cafeteria operate?

SAGE Dining runs the SPX Cafeteria

- All food purchases are charged to your student's account using their ID number - they need their student ID to purchase food in the cafeteria.
- Breakfast is available before school. No food service after school.
- **There is no process to put a limit on what is charged to their account.**
- Parents receive an email each Friday with an itemized list of that week's charges
- All charges are billed to your student's FACTs account.
- Recommend having a conversation with your student as to the acceptable spending.
- There are plenty of students who do not buy lunch, & bring it everyday, or a combination of buying & bringing, based on what's best for each family & student.

When do our students go to homeroom?

- Students go to homeroom four days per week. Live announcements and programming provided by Lion Leaders, Campus Ministry, and Counseling will be rotated during homeroom.
- Homeroom is integrated with all grades (9th - 12th). Each homeroom is part of a larger "House" with various spirit competitions throughout the year.
- Students will have the same homeroom throughout their four years. Younger siblings are in the same "House", but not the same homeroom.

What kind of computer should my student bring to school?

- Refer to the following page for specific information about the Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) specifications: https://spx.org/byod
- Should be larger than a 10 inch screen but not too large so it fits on the classroom desks and in their bags
- Chromebooks may not have all the applications needed - but a PC works well.
- Macbooks are no longer permitted.
- Recommend a backpack with a padded computer sleeve for protection.

How does my student get their books?

- Students purchase books through the EdTech online bookstore. Ordering instructions will be emailed to student accounts each summer around mid-July.
- Student "course access bundles" are created with required books for their course schedule. It's a pretty simple click & buy system.
- Majority are ebook textbooks but you have the option to also buy the hard copy, if desired.
- Some teachers have hard copies for students to borrow or you may be able to find a used copy from an online bookstore. BE SURE TO CHECK THE ISBN &/or VERSION!!
- The course access bundle also includes paperback novels for their English course. You are unable to remove books from your student's book bundle.
- Students access the ebooks through an online portal in Canvas, as needed.
- Summer reading requirements are posted on Canvas. BE SURE TO MATCH THE ISBN when ordering your books for the summer.

How do we know what school supplies our student will need?

+ School supply lists are not provided before the semester begins.
+ Generally, it's up to the student to use what they're most comfortable with (binders, folders, composition notebooks, etc.)
+ For the first couple days, be sure to have some loose leaf paper, a folder, pens, pencils & your computer.
+ Some specific supplies may be required for each class that will be noted on the syllabus & discussed the first couple days of class.
+ Anticipate needing to get a few supplies in the first few days of each semester
+ A graphing calculator (Texas Instruments TI-84+ or equivalent) for Algebra (& pretty much all HS+ level math) is required so watching for Back to School sales is a great idea!

What do I do if my student is sick or needs to be checked out of school for an appointment?

+ Send an email to **attendance@spx.org** to report that your child is sick & will be absent. You may also call the Attendance line 404-636-3023, extension **228** & leave a message. Please call or email by 9:00am.
+ If your student arrives late, they must check in at the Attendance Desk located in the main entrance lobby. Please email or call by 9:00am if your student will be arriving later than 9:00.
+ Your student must present the "seen in the office today" note from the doctor's office at check in to take advantage of a medical tardy check in (see handbook). A note from a parent saying there was a doctor's appointment does not count towards a medical appointment tardy allowance. If you'll be later than 9:00 a.m., please make an effort to call the Attendance Office to let the school know.
+ **If checking a student out at any time during the school day, you must send in a SIGNED note explaining what time you'll be picking up and the nature of why you're checking them out. Your student must deliver this note to the Attendance Desk in the morning before classes begin. Students <u>can not</u> be released with a phone call or email.**
+ If you send in the note, you can wait outside in your car for your student to meet you at your designated time & pick up spot.
+ If it is a last minute appointment, you must come into the school & sign your student out at the Attendance Desk. We encourage you to send a hand-signed note whenever possible.
+ Students with planned absence (college visit, family trip, club sports team event, etc) should get an Informed Absence sheet from the Attendance Office at least 3 days in advance of the missed school day(s), and present a written note from a parent listing reason for absence and date(s) of absence.
+ Students are responsible for referring to Canvas and the respective class's syllabus when absent to keep up with classwork and to plan for makeup work. It is not necessary to notify their teachers of absences or illness by email.

When can my student get a parking pass?

- First-come, first-served lottery-type system. Seniors get priority, then Juniors, & then Sophomores, if space is available. **Freshmen are not allowed to park on campus in any SPX lot.**
- For 26-27, ALL main campus parking is considered "Senior" parking. Only Seniors and underclassmen who have special parking needs will be assigned main campus parking.
- Juniors will be assigned spots at the Shallowford Rd. lot on the far side of the baseball complex. If additional parking is available, Sophomores will be eligible to park at Shallowford.
- Google form is sent to students in late May to sign up for a spot by end of June, and a pass is given only after a student shows a driver's license has been obtained.
- Each annual parking permit is $150, charged to FACTs account

What is PowerSchool & why do I need to know how to access it?

- Consider PowerSchool your student's official school record!
- Where you'll find their class schedule, attendance record, gradebook, report cards, discipline record, locker combination, Works of Mercy recorded.
- Parents update family forms annually each spring.
- Students register for classes in PowerSchool each spring.
- PowerSchool mobile app is useful for quickly viewing daily schedule and grades but doesn't have all the functions as the desktop version.

What is Canvas?

- Online Learning Management System for class management
- Each subject will have a Canvas course created by the teacher to communicate with students - they are not standardized so they will not all be set-up the same!
- Students (& parents) access for syllabus, homework assignments, test/quiz calendar, online resources & ebooks.
- Parents should familiarize themselves & be available to help students learn to manage workflow
- *There are also "courses" on Canvas for departments (Counseling, Academics, etc) to post information, upload slides from presentations, and to communicate with families - they are not standardized so they will not all be set-up the same!*
- *Check the EXTRAS tab to find Campus Ministry, Library, and other student/family-specific resources. The Extras tab is only available on the desktop version of Canvas.*
- ***Electronic Student/Family Directory is posted in Canvas under "Campus Life." There is NO LONGER a print version of the student directory provided to each family. (Family Zip Codes tab allows you to see who lives in/near your area for carpooling purposes.) This is only on the desktop version.***

What are my student's Works of Mercy requirements?

- Campus Ministry will publish updates for the 2026-27 requirements and share with all families at the beginning of the summer.
- Each student is required to complete a minimum number of hours of service each year.
- **Five (5) hours must be completed by the first week of December**
- **Final verification of a minimum of ten (10) total hours must be completed by first week of April**
- Campus Ministry manages the program as a pass/fail grade each school year.
- Students are required to submit and track their WOM/service hours by using the x2 VOL website or app. Campus Ministers will visit Theology classes when school begins to explain the details of the program & how to set up and use the app.
- Projects accomplished after June 1st count for the next school year so keep a record of the point of contact and their contact information through the summer.
- **It is HIGHLY recommended that students record their projects as soon as they finish!!**

What are Works of Mercy?

- Feeding the Hungry or Giving Drink to the Thirsty
- Clothing the Naked or Sheltering the Homeless
- Visiting the Sick or Imprisoned
- Instructing the Ignorant
- Caring for God's Creation
- Please refer to the website and the handbook for what classifies as a Work Of Mercy. There are pre-approved organizations that can be found in the handbook/website starting in June. If your student's organization is not listed, please have them email Campus Ministry to make sure it falls under the WOM guidelines prior to completing the service. (Consult www.spx.org under "Faith" for more specific details.)
- Look out for regular service opportunities provided by SPX Campus Ministry, athletic teams, art disciplines, Mothers' Club and some clubs/activities. They will be sent to your student's emails, through ESpiritus, or in your student's x2Vol Dashboard. Community-based organizations are recommended, as well.
- Feel free to reach out to the Campus Ministry Department via email with any questions.

Are students allowed to go to the Roar Store whenever they want?

- Students are allowed to purchase snacks, drinks, CANDY, limited school supplies at lunch or in between classes, if there's time. The Roar Store is closed during period 7. **Food & Drink are not allowed in the classrooms.
- Very popular with Freshmen - newfound freedom! **Again, no limit on what can be charged to their account.**
- Student purchases are charged to their FACTs account the following month.
- NO itemized Roar Store bill will be sent weekly or monthly.
- Debit & credit card purchases ($5 minimum) are authorized, as well.
- Recommend having an acceptable spending conversation with your student.

+ Visit the Roar Store webpage under “Campus Life” for hours of operations, student account, and return policy details, and follow the instagram page for sales and specials.
+ Parents are always welcome to come shop for spirit wear during the school day but are encouraged to do so while class is in session & avoid class changes.

What kind of library services exist at St. Pius X?

+ The Flannery O’Connor Library is open Monday-Thursday 7:30-4:00, Fridays with late start 8:30-3:30, and during lunches, should a student need to study, do homework or need a respite from the day.
+ The library offers a large collection of print and electronic books for students to check out for pleasure reading and for personal/academic exploration.
+ In addition to books, the library has chromebooks and chromebook chargers to check out should a student forget their personal device or have a technical problem. Chromebooks and chargers may be checked out a total of 15 times **OR** for 30 days for the entire year.
+ There are printers and a copy machine in the library for student use. Black and White copies are $.05 and color copies are $.25 each. Each student starts the school year with a $5 credit.
+ As part of their English curriculum, all freshmen will participate in a Library Orientation early in each semester. During this orientation, students will learn about the policies and procedures that govern the library so students can more fully utilize the space and its resources.
+ The Library services desk is an excellent place to ask questions if you are having any technical difficulties with your device and online resources/websites.
+ Mrs. LeyAnna Messick and Mrs. Eleonora Straub are the librarians.

What is the general expectation for Annual Financial Giving?

+ During the summer, each family is mailed a Philanthropy and Engagement Guide discussing all SPX-sponsored giving opportunities. An Annual Fund gift, which supports the general needs of the school, is the single most important donation one can make to the school and all families are encouraged to participate at whatever level is appropriate for them.
+ After the Philanthropy and Engagement guide is sent, a follow-up email in July will include a Google form link that invites parents to donate to the Annual Fund, followed by requests to purchase memberships for the Mothers’ Club, Athletic Association (AA) and St. Pius X Arts Society (SPAS).
+ Home & School dues are automatically assessed in tuition via FACTs at the beginning of each school year.
+ Mothers’ Club has a flat membership fee and AA and SPAS have levels of membership that include passes/tickets for games & performances, game-day parking spaces and other benefits.
+ The SPX Golden Gala is the largest school-wide fundraising event and it occurs every two years. Families are encouraged to attend both the Gala and the related Class Parties which take place in the fall. The next Gala will be held in 2028. In the off years, Trivia Night is

held in early February open to all parents in the gym.

Are there any general expectations if my student plays a sport?

- Each athletic team has specific information available from coaches & team parents.
- There's usually an informational meeting announced to the students and held several weeks, sometimes months prior to tryouts.
- Students must be present for at least four periods of the day to participate in practice or a game.
- Parent volunteer requirements vary with each team - this is always a great opportunity to meet and get to know other parents.
- It is expected that the athlete participates in the Coke sale fundraiser each season the athlete participates in a respective sport.
- It's highly encouraged for each athlete's family to join the Athletic Association.
- A new sports physical is required each year **dated after April 1st** for the following school year or any summer training.
- Physicals are uploaded via RankOne. Refer to the information located at https://www.spx.org/athletics/inside-athletics/sports-medicine/student-physical-forms

What are some important dates I should have on my calendar?

IMPORTANT DATES AT A GLANCE

LION LUNCHES

- Friday, June 12th and Friday, July 17th from 12-1:30pm
- Students attend the BYO lunch programming with Lion Leaders, and there is a Q&A event available for parents in the auditorium.

NEW STUDENT ORIENTATION and CAMP GOLDEN LION DAY (MANDATORY)

- Tuesday, August 4th - 8:00am - 3:00pm
- Students may dress casually in spirit wear or their house colors. They should bring their computer & a notebook/pen. Lunch will be provided.
- Students & parents are invited to attend Mass. Students remain on campus for the rest of the day. Parents return at 3:00pm to pick up students.
- Parents are invited to a New Parent Coffee immediately following Mass.

FIRST DAY OF SCHOOL

- Wednesday, August 5th - 8:00am - 12:30pm

MINI-CLASS NIGHT (Open House/Meet the Teacher)

- Thursday, August 20th - 6:00pm

HOME AND SCHOOL FAMILY TAILGATE

- Friday, August 21st - 5:30-7:00pm - Senior Lot Lawn

MOTHERS' CLUB OPEN HOUSE

+ Wednesday, August 26th - 7:00pm - Breezeway

FRESHMAN PARENT PARTY

+ Saturday, September 26th - The Arc Plaza

What is Mini-Class Night?

+ Think of this as Open House/Meet the Teachers high-school style for PARENTS ONLY.
+ Parents follow their student's schedule from 1st - 8th period and listen to a short presentation by each teacher about course curriculum, policies & expectations, etc.
+ Opportunity to introduce yourself to your student's teachers but not have a conference.
+ A virtual mini-class night will be held in January at the beginning of second semester.
+ **At least one parent should plan to attend but both are welcome.**

Can you please help me understand uniform requirements?

+ '26-27 Uniform Guidelines PDF attached and posted here.
+ This PDF can be found in "New Family Resources" on the Admissions tab. Be sure to review the uniform and out-of-uniform policy and guidelines in the Student Handbook when the new version is made available before school begins.
+ New families are encouraged to visit the Roar Store during the summer to purchase new uniforms. Hours of operation are posted on the SPX webpage under "Campus Life". The Roar Store staff are great at explaining all the uniform details, tips & tricks!



+ Mother's Club Used Uniforms is a great source of excellent quality uniforms at a fraction of the cost. The uniform racks are set up in a room next to the Roar Store. It's self-serve, everything is charged to FACTs & you check out on an iPad. Parents are always welcome to come shop for uniforms during the school day but are encouraged to do so while class is in session & avoid class changes.

Please note these special policies for the upcoming '26-27 school year:

+ Navy ChiRho polo shirts for grades 9-11 are required for all students for the 2026-27 school year. The old-style polo shirts (St. Pius with laurel wreath in white or navy) are not allowed to be worn.
+ Flynn O'Hara will only sell the new plaid skirt to female students - no new skorts are available for purchase. All used skorts have been removed from Used Uniforms for purchase, as well. Students may wear passed down skorts as long as they meet uniform length requirements per the handbook for this school year only.
+ 5 inch inseam bike shorts are required under all skirts. Available in the Roar Store for purchase.
+ There is no specified "game day" polo.

Spirit Wear & Out of Uniform Days:

There will be several Spirit Days throughout the year, especially the first semester during football & homecoming (HOCO) season as well as other school milestone performances.

+ Dean of Students will send plenty of emails with the out-of-uniform & spirit wear guidelines, but it's a good idea to familiarize yourself with the specifics in the student handbook.
+ On Spirit Days, students must wear a SPX t-shirt/sweatshirt - sometimes it must be a specific t-shirt you purchased for an event (i.e. HOCO).
+ Students are NOT allowed to wear shorts or sweatpants of any kind unless given explicit permission to do so, which is rare (ie. field day, extreme cold weather days)
+ Students must wear nicer jeans (no rips or tears) or khaki-type pants (chinos) and closed-toe footwear that covers heel to toe (no slippers or crocs)
+ For out-of-uniform, it might be themed (ie. patriotic; Christmas) or otherwise just needs to be school appropriate.
+ Occasionally, there are charity fundraisers associated with out-of-uniform and your FACTS account will be charged a specified amount if your student participates.
+ For girls, no leggings, sweatpants, shorts, skirts, dresses or torn jeans/pants are allowed for Spirit days or out-of-uniform.

<table>
<tr><th colspan="3">St. Pius X Catholic High School Uniform Policy 2026-2027</th></tr>
<tr><td>FOOTWEAR</td><td colspan="2">● Athletic Shoes:Black & Black-laced or white-laced only (white trim and white soles are acceptable)
● Dress Shoes: brown or black (i.e. loafers or flats (must cover toe and heel))
● Saddle Shoes (for females) *Must be kept clean and worn properly at all times

● SOLID BLACK, NAVY or WHITE knee or crew socks (ladies & gentlemen) *NO symbols/logos*</td></tr>
<tr><td>TOPS</td><td colspan="2">● Current Senior Polos, available in Roar Store.
● Navy logo Polos, available in the Roar Store.

* Polo shirts are ONLY sold in the Roar Store, not available at Fynn O’Hara</td></tr>
<tr><td>OUTERWEAR</td><td colspan="2">● Navy Blue cotton crewneck or cotton quarter-zip sweatshirt with SPX logo

● SPX Letter Jacket

● SPX Senior Sweatshirt (current senior class 2027 only)

*Uniform-compliant outerwear is ONLY sold in the Roar Store, not available at Flynn O’Hara</td></tr>
<tr><td>BOTTOMS</td><td>GENTLEMEN
● Gray Pants - Flynn O’Hara

● Black, Brown, or Chi Rho Belt</td><td>LADIES
● Skirt - Flynn O’Hara
● 5 inch bike shorts must be worn under skirt (available only in Roar Store)

● Gray Pants - Flynn O’Hara</td></tr>
</table>

HAIR	• Hair must be off the face & out of the eyes - unobstructed. • Natural human hair color only. • Clean, kempt, and professional. • No extensions, no hair tinsel, beads, or ribbons, non-natural hair color; no scarves of any length GENTLEMEN • No facial hair • Sideburns no longer than mid-ear
ACCESSORIES ALLOWED	• Ladies - Two stud or small hoop earrings per ear. • Gentlemen - One single stud per ear • Two necklaces (pendant or pearls). • No visible tattoos • No visible face, nose, or body piercings (except for the earring policy above)